The law enforcement agencies reached the spot, took him in custody and delivered him safely at his home in Lahore.

Another significant high-profile kidnapping for ransom was of Ali Haider Gillani, son of the former Prime Minister of Pakistan, Yousuf Raza Gillani, who was kidnapped during an election campaign event in Multan on 9 May 2013, just two days before the general elections on 11 May 2013. Gillani's personal secretary, Muhammad Mohiuddin, was killed in the attack while one of his personal security guards was wounded. A terrorist group calling itself the Al-Mansooreen Brigade, an affiliate of TTP, claimed responsibility for his abduction. Abu Yazeed, a spokesperson for the Al-Mansooreen Brigade, said, 'Ali Haider Gillani is in our custody and is safe and sound.' Calling from an Afghan phone number, the spokesperson added, 'We will release the video of Mr Gillani shortly after Eid and will apprise about our demands' (Islam, 2013). Reportedly, they demanded Rs 3 billion for his release, but he was released in a counter-terror raid by the US Special Operations Forces and Afghan commandos in eastern Afghanistan in May 2016.

These high-profile kidnappings for ransom were not only aimed at replenishing the depleting coffers of the TTP, but also had a psychological impact of the TTP prowess on the entire populace and especially the government, which further faced the pressure rather than retaliating with a might to establish its writ.

Rana Jawad, Islamabad Bureau Chief of Geo TV, told Central Asia Online that 'The TTP also receive their share from the drugs that cross into Pakistan's North West Frontier and Balochistan provinces'. Abu Rehman Malik, the former Interior Minister of Pakistan, endorsed these views and the findings of the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime (UNDOC) and Sustainable Development Policy Institute (SDPI) and said that illegal money earned through drugs and arms trafficking were being used by terrorists (*The Nation*, 2012). He added that poppy cultivated in Afghanistan directly fuelled terrorism in this region and across the globe as it was widely used for funding weapons supply, trainings and other needs for terrorism by the terrorist organisations. He claimed that the government of Pakistan had also lodged complaints to NATO, but it could do little in this regard probably 'due to its limited mandate' (*The Nation*, 2012). Senator Haji Adeel also backed these views. He said that: